

battery but in a slim device, dual SIM, fast processing speeds and a multi-tasking environment. On the software side, Indian customers are keener on having a personalised handset rather than generic handset-centric applications. So, at our R&D centre, these things are being modified keeping in mind the requirements of Indian customers.

### **Q Can you give an example of a handset that you have customised for the Indian market?**

We have customised the ZTE Grand X especially for the Indian market. Globally, it is a 5 MP handset but for the Indian consumers, we are customising it with an 8 MP camera. We are not changing things on the price side though, since Indian customers require a good camera as they use their smartphones as cameras too. Also, ZTE Grand S is a single SIM device for the worldwide market but for India, we are developing it as a dual SIM handset.

### **Q What about the after-sales service for ZTE devices?**

ZTE is a brand that is known for its after-sales service. We have already established 214 service centres across the country that are equipped with the L2 level of repair facilities. We are amongst the few companies in India that have L3 and L4 level component repair facilities. We have a full-fledged repair factory in Manesar, where we can repair and manufacture PCBs. These service centres have been around for seven years now. So the personnel there are experts in repairing devices and the factory carries the full stock of components required to expedite the process of repairing a device. Customers in India do not have to worry about the after-sales service.

### **Q One major complaint that customers have with the ZTE phones already launched is that they do not have sufficient battery back-up. Have you tried to address this issue?**

I am unsure about whether there is any such complaint as we have already sold around 36 million devices in India, and this figure includes our smartphones as well. We have been able to reach this figure without having an open market presence. But when we started going to the open market, our main focus was on the battery. So all the phones from ZTE in India currently have an average battery of 2000 mAh, which is the starting point. The upcoming four models will have a battery of around 2700 mAh. We are coming up with models that have 2500 mAh batteries as well as 3800 mAh batteries. We are more focused on this aspect as we understand that the battery consumption of Indian customers is very high due to their usage habits. We are concentrating on large batteries fitted into slim devices.

### **Q What about the Firefox phone from ZTE? Are you planning to bring it into the Indian market?**

The device is ready but this phone has to be launched

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with an operator. The simple reason is that it is based on a thin-client network. We have launched the device in the UK market and it is sold out too. But, in India, it has to be launched through some operator because this is an application-centric phone, where all the applications including the customer data have to be on the cloud of the operator. So an operator has to first create the cloud related environment and then only can they go ahead with these phones. The cloud related environment and ecosystem will take some time to be built. On those levels, the Indian market is not yet prepared for the Firefox phones.

### **Q So are you not in discussions about these devices with any of the operators in the country?**

We have already proposed the use of our devices, but the complete creation of a cloud environment for the devices is a big decision. The operator has to first look into the business aspects and conduct a feasibility analysis.

### **Q Most of your devices are based on open source operating systems like Android and Firefox OS. Any reasons for this?**

Open source technology allows us to create and customise devices as per the needs of our customers. In India, Android is so successful that one doesn't need to look beyond this platform. There is awareness and an ecosystem built around Android. So it would not be wise to work on another platform on which all these attributes are yet to be proved successful. The Windows Phone platform is limited as of now and the customers need time to warm up to it. We will continue to focus on Android for the next two years. Right now we are concentrating on the innovations on the hardware side, but going forward, we will innovate on the software side too.

### **Q What is your strategy for entering the open market?**

We have already started with our open market operations. We have tied up with retailers in Maharashtra, Gujarat, MP and the Delhi-NCR region. We are gradually moving towards the southern and the northern parts of the country. 